

VIRTUAL ASSISTANTS FOR YOUR HOME



Virtual assistants for you (Source: <https://firebrandtalent.com>)

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Exercising regularly to stay fit is the top-most New Year's resolution for many. However, every year, most of us fail miserably at following it. This year, however, has been quite different for me. Siri, my personal assistant

(courtesy iPhone), seems to have made its personal goal that I achieve my fitness target. It does everything for me—wake me up early, play the right music for me while guiding me with my workout schedule and then keep a calorie count for everything that I eat. Life with Siri is bliss!

Ranging from Amazon's Alexa to Google Home, Apple's Home Kit to Facebook's much awaited M and Microsoft's Cortana, we have a lot of options to contemplate and choose from based on our needs. While Apple's Siri is great at handling emails and setting up appointments, it is pathetic in giving directions or updates on traffic conditions to a particular destination. Google's OK Google, on the other hand, is amazing with direc-

tions and traffic updates. Nothing can beat Amazon's Alexa when it comes to music. It has mastered the art of playing and suggesting the perfect songs.

Let's now take a look at a few of these artificial intelligence empowered virtual assistants available in India and discover how useful they are in managing your routine household chores.

Amazon Alexa

Alexa is regarded as one of the most viable personal assistants available in the market today. From playing your music to managing schedule, it can do it all. The way Amazon's engineers chose its name is also quite interesting. One of the intriguing *Star Trek* inspired reason is that they